

The Long-Run Effects of Doxxing: Evidence from the Second Ku Klux Klan*

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Abstract

This paper provides the first quantitative evidence on the long-run effects of doxxing by comparing the outcomes of Klansmen outed by the anti-Klan newspaper *Tolerance* to those of their unexposed peers. Linking exposed members who had their names, addresses, and occupations published in *Tolerance* and unexposed members identified from various archival sources to the decennial censuses, I use difference-in-differences and event study techniques to evaluate the long-run impact of being doxxed on individuals' later-life outcomes, particularly migration, job switching, and occupational prestige. Overall, I find that doxxing had no statistically significant effect on any outcomes of interest through 1940, and rule out effect sizes greater than 0.25 standard deviations in either direction for all migration and labor market outcomes. However, for Klansmen whose membership was particularly salient, i.e., business owners and those living in districts with above-median minority representation, I find that being doxxed significantly increases rates of cross-county migration and industry switching. This paper contributes to several literatures, including the economic analysis of the KKK and the effectiveness of consumer boycotts and socially responsible consumption.

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1 Introduction

The practice of doxxing—the act of publicly releasing someone’s personal information as a form of retaliation—is more accessible and widespread today than ever before. The rise of the internet and social media has made it increasingly easy for actors across the political spectrum to locate and widely disseminate individuals’ personally identifiable information and relationship networks. Several high-profile instances of doxxing have occurred in recent years, spurring debate and legislation worldwide. Following the October 7, 2023 attacks in Israel, the conservative media organization Accuracy in Media began publishing the names and photographs of Harvard students associated with 34 student organizations that co-signed a letter blaming Israel for Hamas’ attacks (Schwartz, 2024).¹ On the other side of the aisle, pro-Palestinian activists in Australia recently hacked into a private WhatsApp group and released conversations between Jewish writers, artists, musicians and academics, along with a spreadsheet of their names and other personal information (McGuirk, 2024). This incident led to the passage of federal legislation in Australia in November 2024 classifying doxxing as a criminal offense punishable by up to seven years of imprisonment (Law Library of Congress, 2024).

More recently in the United States, doxxing has been used as a tool on both sides of the debate over the Trump administration’s immigration enforcement efforts. In July 2025, an Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) official testified in court that ICE used lists of pro-Palestinian student protesters compiled and published (i.e., doxxed) by the pro-Israel organization Canary Mission in order to revoke international student visas (Montague, 2025). In the same month, the Department of Homeland Security issued a press release condemning the doxxing of ICE agents in Oregon, classifying the act as an “assault” on the officers and their families (U.S. Department of Homeland Security, 2025). While there are currently no federal laws prohibiting doxxing in the U.S., over thirteen states have passed laws levying

¹Accuracy in Media also enlisted a “doxxing truck” to drive around Harvard’s campus with digital billboards displaying these students’ names and photographs, in addition to creating over 15 websites dedicated to doxxing individual students (Thaler, 2023).

civil or criminal penalties for those found guilty of the act. Yet, despite its prevalence in newsrooms and legislatures, there are no studies to date that evaluate the long-run effects of being doxxed on the outed individual.

This paper aims to fill this gap in the literature by assessing the long-run impacts of a historical incident of doxxing targeting members of one of the most notorious hate groups in American history: the Ku Klux Klan (KKK). Between 1915 and 1925, as many as six million men joined and left the second KKK, a “benevolent, ritualistic, social, and fraternal order” with prejudices against recent immigrants, Catholics, Jews, and Black individuals (Simmons, 1923). At its height, the Klan held formidable political power, boasted one in ten White, Protestant American men as members, and garnered over \$75 million in annual revenue.² Despite its pervasiveness, the Klan also had outspoken adversaries, including Chicago’s American Unity League (AUL). The AUL was founded on June 21, 1922 with the mission to expose and eradicate the Klan in Chicago and nationwide. Its unique weapon was the newspaper *Tolerance*, which published weekly issues listing the names, addresses and occupations of Klansmen across the country, essentially serving as an early outlet for doxxing.

In the inaugural issue of *Tolerance*, AUL Chairman Patrick H. O’Donnell wrote that “many Klansmen are in business or the professions and are dependent largely upon patronage of those groups they classify as alien,” and believed that exposing these prejudices to members’ clientele would be detrimental to their careers and the Klan’s survival (American Unity League, 1922). Anecdotal evidence shows that *Tolerance* was quite effective in achieving its goals. For example, Augustus E. Olsen, President of the Washington Park National Bank in Chicago, was forced to resign in October 1922 after the publication of his name in *Tolerance* led many of his Irish and Jewish depositors to withdraw their funds (Jackson, 1967). I test the prevalence and effectiveness of consumers’ boycott response by linking exposed Klan members listed in *Tolerance* issues and unexposed Klan members from

²In 2025 USD, this would be just over \$1.4 billion per year.

chapter membership rolls to the decennial censuses and tracking their trajectories over time. Specifically, I test if exposed Klan members are more likely to migrate across state or county lines, change occupations or industries of employment, or experience changes in occupational prestige, which are outcomes I can clearly measure using variables from the decennial censuses.

Leveraging data on exposed and unexposed Klan members from over 80 counties, I find that being doxxed led to no statistically significant differences in any outcomes of interest through 1940. Whether informed by within-county or across-county comparisons, the results of various difference-in-differences and event study specifications show that Klan members listed in *Tolerance* were no more or less likely to move across state or county lines, switch occupations or industries of employment, or experience gains or losses in occupational income scores relative to Klansmen who remained unexposed. In my preferred specification, I rule out effect sizes larger than one-quarter of a standard deviation in both directions for all outcomes.

However, this overarching null result masks important heterogeneity in the effects of being doxxed. For individuals whose Klan membership exposure was particularly salient, specifically Klansmen who were self-employed or lived in enumeration districts with relatively higher nonwhite representation, I find statistically significant positive effects on rates of cross-county migration and industry switching. These findings align with the anecdotal evidence presented above, showing the potential role of consumer boycotts by targeted groups in punishing Klan membership in the marketplace.

This work contributes to several literatures. Importantly, this paper provides the first quantitative analysis of the effects of doxxing on the exposed individual, following recent qualitative work on the impact of modern-day doxxing (Amarasingam and Galloway, 2024).³ The historical setting of my paper allows me to go beyond the scope of this work by utilizing administrative data to quantify the long-run effects of exposure instead of relying on

³While tangentially related, the exercise underlying Ederer et al. (2024) does not constitute doxxing (as reported by the authors).

individual victims’ testimonials of short-run effects.

Second, this paper builds on the economic analysis of the second Klan and its origins. Fryer and Levitt (2012) provides the first in-depth economic analysis of the KKK, exploiting membership records and hood order forms from various cities around the U.S. to describe who joined the Klan and assess its social and political impacts. They document substantial geographic heterogeneity in Klan member characteristics and note that the group was far more successful in recruiting and fundraising than in electing favored candidates or implementing desired policies. More recently, Ang (2023) examines the role of the first American blockbuster, *The Birth of a Nation*, on the spread of racial violence and Klan chapters, called Klaverns. Exploiting the path of the film’s release tour in 1915, he finds that counties that screened the film experienced a fourfold increase in the likelihood of lynchings and race riots in the following month and a 60 percentage point increase in the likelihood of Klavern formation in the following 25 years. Bazzi et al. (2023) also uses Klavern and Klan membership data to show that counties with more migrants from the former Confederacy are more likely to host a local Klan chapter, and find that male migrants from the south and their sons are more likely to join the Klan than their non-southern neighbors. It’s important to note that while Ang (2023) and Bazzi et al. (2023) use Klan activity as an outcome, I am more interested in Klan membership as a treatment or feature, like Fryer and Levitt (2012). I contribute to this analysis by disentangling the characteristics of Klan members (their paper) from the effect of being exposed as a Klan member (this paper).

Third, this paper contributes to our understanding of socially responsible consumption, consumer boycotting, and social exclusion. Findings about the effectiveness of socially responsible consumption and consumer boycotting are mixed. In a theoretical model with many socially responsible consumers, Kaufmann et al. (2024) finds that even the most socially conscious consumers still purchase externality-generating goods after internalizing the equilibrium effects of reducing their own consumption to 0. In related work on socially responsible investors, Broccardo et al. (2023) finds that the choice to boycott and divest from

a firm (exit) versus advocate/vote for “better” behavior (voice) depends on the share of socially responsible investors. If the majority (minority) of investors are socially responsible, then voice achieves the socially optimal outcome (exit is a more effective strategy). Moving away from the market context, Ramos-Toro (2023) discusses the intergenerational effects of socially excluding lepers in Columbia, finding higher rates of in-group altruism among descendants of the excluded and more mistrust of formerly exclusionary actors (in this case, medical professionals). While he focuses on second-generation effects, I explore the effects of potential social exclusion on the first generation (exposed Klan members).

The remainder of the paper proceeds in the usual manner.

2 Historical Background

There have been three distinct iterations of the KKK in American history. White men in the former Confederacy formed the First Klan just after the Civil War to stall or stop any attempts at northern-led Reconstruction. This regional organization permeated throughout the South and used violence and intimidation tactics to deny the Black population their newly recognized rights. Most active from 1865 to 1872, it was officially disbanded by Grand Wizard (national leader) Nathan Bedford Forrest in 1869 after a series of bills signed into law by President Grant authorized the use of federal troops to disrupt Klan activities. The Third Klan, formed in 1946 and most prevalent in the 1960s, is the iteration that most readers likely envision when they think of the KKK. Still extant today, the modern Klan is a collection of independent, rival hate groups all bearing the name “Ku Klux Klan” with various modifiers. The Third Klan was actively and violently opposed to school integration and Black enfranchisement in the 1950s and 60s, targeted communists and communist sympathizers in the 70s and 80s, and in more recent decades has embraced neo-Nazi stances and symbols in addition to harsher anti-immigrant views.

The focus of this paper, however, is on the Second Klan, the iteration with the largest

size and scope in terms of membership and geographic coverage. At its peak, the Second Klan was at least four times the size of the original Klan and notably billed itself as a fraternal, social organization as opposed to a violent paramilitary. Despite arguably having the greatest influence, the Second Klan was also the shortest lived. I summarize the rise and fall of the Second Klan below, largely guided by Jackson (1967).

2.1 The Second Ku Klux Klan

On Thanksgiving Eve, 1915, William Joseph Simmons and fifteen men climbed Stone Mountain near Atlanta, GA and burned a cross, signaling the rebirth of the Reconstruction-era Ku Klux Klan. Inspired by a glorified depiction of the original Klansmen in the nation's first blockbuster, *The Birth of a Nation*, Simmons' goal was to establish a "benevolent, ritualistic, social, and fraternal order" with overt prejudices against recent immigrants, Catholics, Jews, and Black individuals (Ang, 2023; Simmons, 1923).

The second iteration of the KKK largely struggled for its first five years. The organization faced consistent recruiting and financial difficulties, and its roughly 2,000 members were essentially limited to Georgia and Alabama. This changed rapidly in 1920 with the recruitment of Edward Young Clarke. In the spring of 1920, Clarke reached an agreement with Simmons to become Imperial Kleagle (head of the Klan's Department of Propagation). Incentivized with a healthy commission of \$2.50 per new recruit, Clarke and his business partner, Mrs. Elizabeth Tyler, hired over 200 new Kleagles (recruiters) and signed up over 100,000 new members nationwide within a year. Aided by a *New York World* exposé in September 1921 detailing the group's strength and accusing members of over 152 violent acts, the group gained national attention and paradoxically soon exploded to over a million members.

The organization's unfettered rise was short-lived. As a result of the attention generated by the *World*, it came to light that both Edward Clarke and Elizabeth Tyler had been arrested as recently as 1919 on various affair-related charges including intoxication, public

indecent and disorderly conduct. Sects of the “highly moral” Klan immediately called for their removal, but Simmons was unwilling or unable to reprimand his best recruiters. He instead revoked the charter of a Klavern (chapter) who passed a resolution against the two, and banished four members that explicitly called for Clarke’s resignation. This sparked the beginning of the end for Simmons, who garnered growing criticism in the following months for taking long vacations, misappropriating funds, proving to be an ineffective political ally, and displaying general ineptitude.

Things came to a head in November 1922 at the first Imperial Klonvocation (national convention) in Atlanta. An elaborate scheme by the Imperial Night Hawk (national investigator) and three Grand Dragons (state commanders) led Simmons to abdicate his title of Imperial Wizard in favor of the perpetual, yet meaningless, title of Emperor. Hiram Wesley Evans, a rising Texas Klansman, was appointed as Simmons’ “temporary” successor and served as Imperial Wizard for the next seventeen years.

It took Simmons several months to realize what had occurred, but in April 1923 he founded a women’s branch of the Ku Klux Klan called “Kamelia” in a last-chance bid to restore his influence. This drew the ire of Hiram Evans, who already had his own plans to subsume several women’s societies into the Klan. Their disagreement grew into a series of public battles between Simmons and Evans, including a property battle over the Imperial Palace in Atlanta that culminated in several lawsuits in the Fulton County courts. On May 1, 1923, a settlement was reached. Hiram Evans would remain Imperial Wizard, and William Simmons would receive \$146,000 in exchange for his rights to the rituals, regalia and signs of the Ku Klux Klan. On January 5, 1924, Simmons was officially banished from the Klan.

While it survived for several more years, the Second Klan never truly recovered from Simmons’ forced departure. Klaverns around the country, especially in the cities, were evenly split by the Evans-Simmons debate. Thousands of members were disillusioned with the organization entirely and ceased paying dues. These issues were only compounded by further internal scandals. Notably, in Indiana—the state with the most Klan members in

absolute and per capita terms—Grand Dragon D. C. Stephenson was arrested and convicted in 1925 for the abduction, rape and murder of Madge Augustine Oberholtzer. The largest Klan in the country subsequently splintered and disappeared over the next two years.

2.2 The Anti-Klan Movement

While the Second Klan did a fine job of tearing itself down, it had help from a number of organizations and political opponents during the 1920s. By limiting membership to native-born White, Protestant men, the KKK stood in opposition to all non-White people, immigrants, Catholics, and non-Christians — particularly Jews. Each of these targeted groups engaged in various forms of anti-Klan activism (Goldberg, 1996).⁴

Perhaps surprisingly, of these minority groups the Klan was most concerned with the growing influence of Catholics in the United States. While Black people were already treated as second-class citizens in much of the country, and non-Christians made up a rather small portion of the population, first- and second-generation Catholic immigrants were viewed as an imminent threat to the Klan’s activities and ideals. Exacerbated by post-war nationalism, the tenet of loyalty to the United States was essential to the Klan’s ideal of “one hundred percent Americanism.” Klansmen viewed Catholics as beholden to the will of the Pope over the President, and therefore as a disloyal and dangerous faction. Because of this targeting, some of the strongest anti-Klan organizations were primarily Catholic, including the American Unity League.

As stated, the Chicago-based American Unity League (AUL) was founded on June 21, 1922 by Robert H. Shepherd, Grady K. Rutledge and Joseph G. Keller with the mission of eradicating the Klan’s presence in Chicago and nationwide. The AUL relied on paid investigators and frustrated former Klansmen to acquire Klavern membership rolls, which were then compiled and published in their weekly newspaper, *Tolerance*. The publication was a rapid success. The first list of 150 Chicago Klansmen was published on September

⁴While not the focus of this article, there were also widespread political movements against the Ku Klux Klan in the 1920s (e.g., anti-mask statutes and the “Walker Law”).

17, 1922, and all 2,700 copies were quickly purchased by a predominantly Catholic audience. A reprint the following week sold 17,500 copies, and by the end of 1922 *Tolerance* had a circulation of 150,000.

There are numerous anecdotes of the adverse effects of being listed in an issue of *Tolerance*. In addition to the story of Augustus E. Olsen, salesman William R. Toppan testified in court that after being listed in *Tolerance*, members of minority groups “from thence hitherto wholly refused and still do refuse to have any transaction, acquaintance, or discourse with me as they were before used and accustomed to have.” Another Chicago milkman reported that after his name was listed in an issue, several Black-owned establishments he serviced cut ties with his firm. I test whether these types of exclusionary reactions were frequent and severe enough for their impact to be seen in the decennial censuses several years later.

Despite its successes in exposing thousands of Klansmen and garnering a wide public response, the AUL and its tactics were not without fault. In addition to using unscrupulous tactics to acquire membership rolls, including duping former Klansmen out of agreed-upon finders fees, the AUL was also guilty of publishing the names of some non-members that particular investigators or informants had personal disagreements with. The most notable instance was when millionaire gum manufacturer William Wrigley Jr. was falsely listed as a Klan member on New Year’s Eve, 1922.⁵ The mogul promptly issued a public denial, sued the AUL for \$50,000 and offered another \$50,000 to any organization that could prove he signed an application. This particular scandal was quickly resolved when AUL informant W. J. Winston admitted that Wrigley’s application was a forgery, but several similar lawsuits were filed against the organization. In addition to this wave of lawsuits, the AUL was struck by further scandal when it was revealed that the head of their New York office, charged with replicating Chicago’s success on the East Coast, was actually a paid spy of the Ku Klux Klan. The organization never recovered from this reputational blow, and shuttered due to

⁵There were fierce internal disagreements about the validity of Wrigley’s application and the decision to publish his name. One founder of the AUL, Grady K. Rutledge, was so frustrated by the scandal that he defected to the Ku Klux Klan.

bankruptcy by 1925.

3 Data

My objective is to identify the differential effect of being exposed as a member of the Ku Klux Klan relative to remaining unexposed on a variety of later-life outcomes. To inform my estimates, I gather data on exposed and unexposed Klan members from *Tolerance* issues and archival sources, then link them to the decennial censuses to track their outcomes over time. For most locations/counties in my sample, members are either all exposed or all unexposed. There are only two counties in my sample with both doxxed and unexposed members: Denver County, CO and Marion County, IN. I explain how I leverage the structure of my data to make a series of complementary comparisons in section 4.

My treatment group of exposed Klan members consists of individuals listed in various issues of *Tolerance*, which was published by the American Unity League in weekly installments from September 10, 1922 until January 4, 1925. To date, my sample includes names from 49 weekly issues, roughly half of the issues ever published, and a special midweek publication listing every Klan member from Marion County, IN, totaling 17,207 exposed members across all issues.⁶ *Tolerance* was originally founded to expose Chicago-area Klansmen, but expanded in scope over time to reveal members from 12 states and Washington, DC. The extent of information available on these exposed Klan members differs by location: Names are listed for members from all cities, but residential street addresses and occupations are only available for about three-quarters of the treatment group. The information present in each *Tolerance* issue determines how many fields can be used when linking members to the 1920 census, and therefore not all members are linked using the same criteria. Appendix Table A1 lists the member information available for each location exposed by *Tolerance*.

I have located and digitized half of the *Tolerance* issues ever published. This means I am missing a subset of exposed Klan members in my data, which could cause problems

⁶These are not unique members, as some names appear in multiple *Tolerance* issues.

in two ways. First, if a town classified as unexposed in my sample was actually included in an unseen issue of *Tolerance*, then estimates from my cross-county comparisons would be attenuated. Second, if I only capture some of the exposed Klan members from a town classified as exposed in my sample, then estimates from my within-county comparisons would be attenuated. In either case, the attenuation comes from erroneously including treated (exposed) Klan members in my control (unexposed) group. Therefore, the results reported in section 5 are likely of a smaller magnitude than would be observed with “perfect” data.

To form my control group of unexposed Klan members, I use archival records of KKK membership applications, cards, and dues ledgers to identify Klan members from Denver, CO (29,635), Hamilton County, IN (453), Knoxville, TN (445), and Marion County, IN (922). Again, the member information available, and therefore the criteria used to link individuals to the census, differs by location and archival source.

For the greater Denver area, I rely on existing membership ledgers. Data on Colorado Klan members come from two Ku Klux Klan membership books compiled for administrative purposes between 1924 and 1926 and digitized by History Colorado in 2021 (History Colorado, 2021). These books list each member’s name, residential address, and business address.

For my Indiana locations and Knoxville, TN, I compile membership lists from primary sources including Klan membership applications (Form No. 1000 and short-form), membership and dues records (Form K-102), and citizenship petitions (Form K-108). Each of these forms list members’ names and residential addresses, but Forms 1000 and K-102 contain additional details including occupation, place of birth, level of education, church attendance, and more.⁷ Appendix Figure A1 shows an example of Form K-102, which is the source most commonly used in forming the control group.

To assess the impact of exposure on later-life outcomes, I match the full set of exposed and unexposed Klan members to the full-count 1920 census from Ruggles et al. (2024a,b)

⁷Form 1000 also contains information about the applicant’s parents, spouse, children, and seven references that can verify the information provided.

using a method similar to the manual linking in Fetter et al. (2024). I link primarily based on name and state of residence, but also include residential address and occupation when available. I then link these individuals to the 1900-1940 censuses using established links from the Census Tree (Buckles et al., 2023; Price et al., 2021), which has a higher match rate compared to other census links, such as those from the Multigenerational Longitudinal Panel (MLP) project (Helgertz et al., 2024).

Through both manual matching and a tiered automated linking process, I link a total of 9347 Klansmen to the 1920 census. In order to create a two-period panel, I must link individuals across at least three consecutive censuses (1910-1930) in order to construct outcome variables for changing state of residence, county of residence, occupation, and industry of employment for 1920 and 1930. I successfully link 6757 Klansmen (72% of the 1920 sample) from 1910-1930 for inclusion in my baseline difference-in-differences regressions spanning 1920-1930. Differences in 1920 observables for linked and unlinked subsamples are shown in Table 1.

Table 1: Linked from 1910-1930 vs. Unlinked

	Unlinked (N=2590)		Linked (N=6757)		Diff. in Means	Std. Error
	Mean	Std. Dev.	Mean	Std. Dev.		
Age	37.464	14.315	33.418	11.882	-4.045	0.316
Occscore	28.466	11.086	28.286	10.644	-0.180	0.271
Rural	0.180	0.384	0.212	0.409	0.033	0.009
Farmer	0.074	0.262	0.114	0.318	0.040	0.006
Owner	0.387	0.487	0.490	0.500	0.103	0.011
Married	0.608	0.488	0.676	0.468	0.067	0.011

Means of 1920 observables for Klansmen who were successfully linked from 1910-1930 and those that were not.

Linked and unlinked Klansmen do not differ in terms of occupational income score, a historical proxy for income, but there are statistically significant differences in the remaining 1920 characteristics. Linked Klansmen are slightly more likely to live in rural areas or on farms, and are much more likely to own their home and be married in 1920. Linked Klansmen

are also an average of four years younger than their unlinked counterparts. These differences reflect well known selection into consecutive census linkages: younger individuals are more likely to survive to the next decade, and those who are married and own homes are less likely to migrate, increasing their likelihood of being successfully linked.

For my event study variations, I link Klansmen from 1900-1940 in order to generate outcome variables from 1910-1940. 4267 Klansmen (45% of the 1920 sample) can be linked across these five consecutive censuses. Differences in 1920 observables for these linked and unlinked subsamples are shown in Table 2.

Table 2: Linked from 1900-1940 vs. Unlinked

	Unlinked (N=5080)		Linked (N=4267)		Diff. in Means	Std. Error
	Mean	Std. Dev.	Mean	Std. Dev.		
Age	35.354	14.464	33.569	10.213	-1.784	0.256
Occscore	28.311	11.052	28.361	10.445	0.050	0.237
Rural	0.200	0.400	0.207	0.405	0.007	0.008
Farmer	0.095	0.294	0.112	0.315	0.017	0.006
Owner	0.445	0.497	0.482	0.500	0.037	0.010
Married	0.594	0.491	0.733	0.443	0.139	0.010

Means of 1920 observables for Klansmen who were successfully linked from 1900-1940 and those that were not.

Once again, the average linked Klansman is almost two years younger than his unlinked counterpart, and is more likely to live on a farm, own his home, and be married. However, there are still no statistically significant differences in occupational income score across the two groups, lending credibility to the representativeness of the linked sample in terms of labor market outcomes.

I also compare the 1920 observables between doxxed and unexposed Klansmen within each of these linked and unlinked subsamples, and find very limited differences overall. The only significant difference appears to be in homeownership rates between exposed and unexposed individuals in the unlinked samples: Exposed unlinked Klansmen are seven to ten percentage points more likely to own their home relative to unexposed unlinked Klansmen.

More information on baseline differences between exposed and unexposed Klansmen is presented in section 5

4 Empirical Strategy

My ultimate empirical objective is to identify the differential effect of being outed as a member of the Ku Klux Klan relative to remaining unexposed on that individual’s later-life outcomes. I estimate this effect using a series of difference-in-differences (DiD) specifications, each of which carries its own advantages and drawbacks.

The ideal data to pin down this effect would consist of complete rosters of Klan members where some members are randomly exposed in *Tolerance* and the rest remain unexposed. I could then link these individuals to the decennial censuses and identify the effect of being doxxed by subtracting the pre- and post-treatment differences between the treatment and control groups’ outcomes:

$$\begin{aligned} \beta = & [\mathbb{E}(Y \mid Exposed = 1, Post = 1) - \mathbb{E}(Y \mid Exposed = 0, Post = 1)] - \\ & [\mathbb{E}(Y \mid Exposed = 1, Post = 0) - \mathbb{E}(Y \mid Exposed = 0, Post = 0)] \end{aligned} \quad (1)$$

This β corresponds to the coefficient of interest in a standard two-way fixed effects with individual and time (decade) fixed effects. However, because my sample consists of exposed and unexposed Klan members in multiple locations, I include county-by-decade fixed effects to account for any county-specific time shocks and focus solely on the within-county variation in exposure. Formally, I estimate

$$Y_{ict} = \beta(Exposed_i \times Post_t) + \gamma_i + \phi_{ct} + e_{ict} \quad (2)$$

where for individual i in county c at time t , Y_{ict} is my outcome of interest, $Exposed_i$ is an indicator for ever being listed in *Tolerance*, $Post_t$ is an indicator for a census year after

1920, and γ_i and ϕ_{ct} are individual and county-by-time (county-by-decade) fixed effects, respectively. My primary outcomes of interest are migration across state and county lines, changing occupations or industries of employment, and occupational income score. For the first four outcomes, Y_{ict} is an indicator variable for whether individual i lived in the same state/county or worked in the same occupation/industry in period t as they did in period $t - 1$. Changes are computed using census information from 1900–1940, yielding Y_{ict} for $t \in \{1910, 1920, 1930, 1940\}$. The main parameter of interest, β , represents the differential change in Y for Klan members from county c who were exposed relative to those who remained unexposed. This approach is ideal because it holds both Klan membership status and county of membership constant, allowing for the cleanest and most direct comparison between exposed and unexposed Klan members.

However, because the AUL typically published the info of all Klan members they identified in a particular location, there are very few areas with the within-county variation in exposure required to inform our estimate of β : In my sample, only Denver County, CO and Marion County, IN contain both exposed and unexposed Klan members. Therefore, I supplement this approach by comparing the trajectories of Klan members from counties where the AUL acquired and published membership rolls to members from counties where all members remained unexposed in a standard 2x2 difference-in-differences framework. This approach allows me to hold Klan membership constant across observations, but may not pin down the causal effect of membership exposure if the effects of Klan membership differ by county even in the absence of *Tolerance* exposure.

While there are drawbacks to each of these approaches, considered jointly they should paint a cohesive picture on the effects of being outed as a Klan member on an individual's later-life outcomes.

4.1 Within-County: Exposed vs. Unexposed Members

My primary specification employs the individual and county-by-time fixed effects approach detailed in equation 2, which allows me to compare exposed Klan members listed in *Tolerance* to unexposed Klan members within their own county. By holding both Klan membership and county of residence constant, this approach allows me to isolate the effect of being outed as a member of the KKK from any potential economic and social effects of membership, which may differ by county.

Our main identifying assumption is that absent any *Tolerance* publications, the outcomes of Klan members who were listed in *Tolerance* issues would have followed the same trajectory as Klan members who remained unexposed. While I cannot directly test this parallel trends assumption, I can estimate an event study to see if there are any differences in pre-treatment trends between the exposed and unexposed Klan members to provide support for or against it. Formally, I estimate an event study of the form

$$Y_{ict} = \sum_{j=-2}^1 \beta_j (Exposed_i \times \mathbb{1}(t = j)) + \gamma_i + \phi_{ct} + e_{ict} \quad (3)$$

where j indexes decades relative to the first treated census (1930) and $j = -1$ (1920) serves as the omitted/comparison period. In addition to helping us identify any potentially concerning pre-trends, the event study also lets us examine how the effects of Klan membership exposure may change over time from 1930-1940.

Note that since each individual is only observed in the census once per decade and all *Tolerance* issues were published between the 1920 and 1930 censuses, my specification should not suffer from the staggered treatment timing issue of comparing treated to not-yet-treated units. However, because some Klan members were exposed in earlier issues of *Tolerance* than others, my estimate will represent an average of treatment effects of varying lengths.

Again, the main concern with this specification is that most counties in the analysis sample don't contain any variation in exposure status, i.e. consist entirely of exposed or

unexposed members. Denver County, CO and Marion County, IN are the only counties in my sample that contain both exposed and unexposed Klan members, meaning there are relatively few within-county comparisons informing our estimate of β . Because of this lack of within-county variation, for inference we are relying on the implicit assumption that the effect of being exposed as a Klan member is homogeneous across all the different counties in our sample (and may lack the power to detect a statistically significant result). I address these concerns with additional specifications detailed in section 4.2.

4.2 Across-County: Exposed vs. Unexposed Members

In a secondary specification, I compare the trajectories of Klan members from counties where the AUL acquired and published membership rolls to members from counties where all members remained unexposed in a standard 2x2 difference-in-differences framework.⁸ Specifically, I compare exposed Klan members from 85 counties listed in *Tolerance* issues to unexposed Klan members from three counties identified from archival sources.⁹ Formally, for individual i in county c at time t , I estimate

$$Y_{ict} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 Exposed_c + \beta_2 Post_t + \beta_3 (Exposed_c \times Post_t) + e_{ict} \quad (4)$$

where β_3 now represents the differential impact of being a Klan member from a county where membership was exposed relative to being a Klan member from a county where membership remained hidden.

This approach allows me to hold Klan membership constant across observations and greatly expand my effective sample size, but relies on the assumption that the effects of Klan membership did not and would not differ by county in the absence of *Tolerance* expo-

⁸In counties where I have both exposed and unexposed members, I include the larger of the treatment and control groups. That is, I include exposed Klansmen from Marion County, IN and unexposed Klansmen from Denver County, CO in addition to Klansmen from locations where everyone was either exposed or unexposed.

⁹Unexposed Klan members come from Denver County, CO, Hamilton County, IN, and Knox County, TN. A list of locations with at least 100 exposed members can be found in Appendix Table A1.

sure. Again, I cannot prove this assumption holds true, but I can provide support for it by examining if there are differential pre-trends between eventual Klan members from counties where *Tolerance* would and would not eventually expose members. To do so, I estimate an event study of the form

$$Y_{ict} = \theta Exposed_c + \sum_{j=-2}^1 \beta_j (Exposed_c \times \mathbb{1}(t = j)) + \phi_t + e_{ict} \quad (5)$$

where j again indexes decades relative to the first treated census (1930) and $j = -1$ serves as the omitted/comparison period. If $\hat{\beta}_{-2}$ is a tightly identified zero, this provides some support that future members from exposed and unexposed counties were tracking similarly before the Klan’s arrival.

5 Within-County Comparisons

5.1 Baseline Results

As described in section 4.1, I start by comparing exposed and unexposed members from Denver County, CO and Marion County, IN using a difference-in-differences specification with individual and county-by-decade fixed effects. This approach effectively allows me to compare the outcomes of exposed Klansmen to those of unexposed Klansmen in the same county.

Balance tables of 1920 observables for exposed and unexposed Klansmen from Denver, CO and Marion County, IN are shown in Tables 3 and 4, respectively. It is important to note that pre-treatment differences in observables alone do not indicate a potential violation of the parallel trends assumption, as we care more that Klan member characteristics change similarly over time in the exposed and unexposed groups. The values of $\hat{\beta}_{-2}$ in the associated event studies are better indicators of this behavior.

Table 3: Balance of 1920 Observables in Denver County, CO

	Unexposed (N=3321)		Exposed (N=90)		Diff. in Means	Std. Error
	Mean	Std. Dev.	Mean	Std. Dev.		
Age	35.809	13.075	37.978	11.694	2.169	1.253
Occscore	28.808	10.863	35.619	14.925	6.811	1.641
Rural	0.125	0.331	0.000	0.000	-0.125	0.006
Farmer	0.061	0.238	0.000	0.000	-0.061	0.004
Owner	0.422	0.494	0.444	0.500	0.022	0.053
Married	0.643	0.479	0.689	0.466	0.046	0.050
Δ State	0.297	0.457	0.246	0.434	-0.051	0.055
Δ County	0.454	0.498	0.385	0.490	-0.070	0.062
Δ Occupation	0.685	0.465	0.750	0.439	0.065	0.070
Δ Industry	0.672	0.470	0.756	0.435	0.084	0.069

Means of 1920 observables for Klansmen from Denver County, CO who were listed in *Tolerance* and those that were not.

In Denver, Klansmen who were eventually exposed have higher occupational occupational income scores and are less likely to live in rural areas or on farms in 1920 relative to Klansmen who remained unexposed.¹⁰ However, these differences don't appear to influence our outcomes of interest in the pre-treatment period: there are no significant differences in migration rates across state or county lines or the likelihood of changing occupations or industries in 1920 between eventually exposed and unexposed members in Denver.

We see largely similar patterns in Marion County, IN. Klansmen who were eventually doxxed are older, have higher occupational income scores, and are less likely to live in a rural area or farm in 1920 relative to unexposed members. Once again, these differences don't seem to influence our outcomes before treatment: there are no statistically significant differences in the four remaining migration and labor market outcomes between the two groups in 1920.

¹⁰Exposed Denver Klansmen are also significantly older at the 10% level.

Table 4: Balance of 1920 Observables in Marion County, IN

	Unexposed (N=335)		Exposed (N=3826)		Diff. in Means	Std. Error
	Mean	Std. Dev.	Mean	Std. Dev.		
Age	31.406	12.220	33.911	12.776	2.505	0.699
Occscore	25.823	8.562	27.960	10.314	2.136	0.525
Rural	0.346	0.476	0.225	0.418	-0.121	0.027
Farmer	0.164	0.371	0.114	0.318	-0.050	0.021
Owner	0.481	0.500	0.472	0.499	-0.009	0.029
Married	0.624	0.485	0.659	0.474	0.035	0.028
Δ State	0.091	0.288	0.122	0.327	0.030	0.018
Δ County	0.321	0.468	0.353	0.478	0.032	0.028
Δ Occupation	0.723	0.449	0.687	0.464	-0.036	0.037
Δ Industry	0.682	0.467	0.676	0.468	-0.005	0.039

Means of 1920 observables for Klansmen from Marion County, IN who were listed in *Tolerance* and those that were not.

Again, in my baseline specification I regress our five outcomes of interest on a treatment indicator for being exposed in *Tolerance* along with individual and county-by-year fixed effects, shown in equation 2. I first evaluate the short-run effects of doxxing by limiting the analysis period from 1920-1930. Results are presented in Table 5.

Table 5: Within-County Comparison: 1920-1930

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed x Post	0.013 (0.026)	-0.019 (0.035)	-0.008 (0.047)	-0.018 (0.043)	-0.520 (0.576)
Num.Obs.	12 465	12 465	8924	9474	12 320
R2	0.652	0.651	0.745	0.778	0.816
1920 Mean	0.194	0.394	0.688	0.676	28.33
Individual FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
County-Year FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

Comparing outcomes from 1920 and 1930, the outcomes of doxxed Klansmen were not statistically different from the outcomes of unexposed Klansmen from their county. Doxxed

Klansmen are no more or less likely to migrate across state or county lines relative to their unexposed counterparts. They are also no more or less likely to change jobs or industries of employment and experience no increases or decreases in occupational income scores relative to their peers. Comparing the 95% confidence intervals of these estimates to the standard deviations of each outcome, I can rule out any effects of doxxing greater than ± 0.25 standard deviations for all outcomes. Confidence intervals show that the estimated effect of treatment on moving states is bounded between -0.10 and $+0.17$ standard deviations (-3.8 to $+6.4$ percentage points), while the effect on moving counties ranges from -0.19 to $+0.11$ standard deviations (-8.7 to $+4.9$ percentage points). The effect on changing occupations is bounded between -0.21 and 0.18 standard deviations (-10.1 to 8.5 percentage points), while the effect on industry switching is bounded between -0.22 and 0.14 standard deviations (-10.2 to 6.7 percentage points). Finally, the effect on occupational income scores (occscore) is bounded between -0.15 and $+0.06$ standard deviations (-1.65 to 0.61 units).

These statistically insignificant effects persist when the period of analysis is extended from 1910-1940 (Table 6). Following members across this extended period, I can rule out doxxing having an effect greater than ± 0.2 standard deviations for any outcomes of interest through 1940.

Table 6: Within-County Comparison: 1910-1940

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed x Post	0.006 (0.020)	0.016 (0.027)	0.008 (0.045)	0.000 (0.039)	-0.723 (0.499)
Num.Obs.	22 214	22 214	14 809	15 211	20 758
R2	0.434	0.442	0.553	0.590	0.697
1920 Mean	0.194	0.394	0.688	0.676	28.33
Individual FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
County-Year FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

+ $p < 0.1$, * $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

Pivoting to an event study approach to examine how the effects of doxxing may change

over time, Figure A2 again shows statistically insignificant effects of being doxxed throughout the sample period. Point estimates in both the pre- and post-treatment periods are close to 0 for all five outcomes relative to their 1920 means, although confidence intervals are relatively wide for the interstate and intrastate migration outcomes. The statistically insignificant pre-treatment coefficients ($\hat{\beta}_2$) provide some support in favor of the parallel trends assumption that Klansmen who were eventually doxxed would've followed the same trajectories as unexposed Klansmen in the absence of treatment, although tighter confidence intervals would provide stronger evidence for this claim.

In alternative specifications detailed in appendix section C.1, I estimate a series of difference-in-differences models on the Denver and Marion County samples separately and continue to find statistically insignificant effects in these single-county subsamples. The results of a TWFE model with individual and time fixed effects estimated on a sample of only Marion County Klansmen rule out any effects larger than ± 0.25 standard deviations for all outcomes of interest. The same regression estimated on a sample of only Denver County Klansmen rules out effects larger than ± 0.4 standard deviations for migration and occupational prestige outcomes and effects larger than ± 0.6 standard deviations for changing occupations or industries of employment.¹¹ Taken together, the results from the within-county specifications show that being doxxed had no statistically significant effect on the migration habits or labor market outcomes of exposed Klansmen.

It's possible that the null effect being doxxed could be tied to the lack of diversity in the studied communities. In 1920, both Denver and Marion were predominantly White and Protestant counties. If the potential effect of being doxxed is primarily driven by consumers' boycott response, it's unsurprising that the revelation of racist and anti-Catholic preferences wouldn't elicit a large response in areas with such low minority representation. I explore this mechanism along with other scenarios where doxxing would be expected to have a more noticeable effect below.

¹¹The wider confidence intervals in the Denver sample are due to the relatively small treatment group compared to the control group.

5.2 Heterogeneity in Denver and Marion Counties

The results in section 5.1 show that overall, being doxxed did not influence Klansmen’s migration and labor market outcomes through 1940. However, it is possible that this null result masks heterogeneity for particular types of Klan members whose membership exposure may have been more salient. In the anecdotal evidence presented in Jackson (1967) and section 1, doxxed Klansmen who lost their jobs or clientele were frequently self-employed/entrepreneurs or regularly interacting with members of minority/targeted groups. In either of these cases, one could reasonably expect a larger impact of being outed as a Klan member. For Klan-affiliated entrepreneurs, consumers can more clearly associate an individual Klansman’s beliefs to a business they can potentially boycott, as opposed to a wage-earning Klansman that may fill a small role in a larger corporation. The same logic applies to a Klansman that regularly interacts with members of groups that the Klan targeted, including nonwhite individuals, immigrants, Jews, and Catholics. For example, a Chicago route salesman testified that after being listed in an issue of *Tolerance*, members of minority groups “from thence hitherto wholly refused and still refuse to have any transaction, acquaintance or discourse with me as they were before used and accustomed to have.”

I test if these specific groups were more impacted by being doxxed by interacting treatment with indicators for being self-employed in 1920 or living in an enumeration district (ED) with an above-median share of nonwhite residents in 1920. These specifications take the form of equation 6, with $Subset_i$ acting as a placeholder for the relevant dummy variables indicating self-employment and living in a minority enumeration district.

$$Y_{ict} = \beta_1(Exposed_i \times Post_t) + \beta_2(Exposed_i \times Post_t \times Subset_i) + \gamma_i + \phi_{ct} + e_{ict} \quad (6)$$

Results of these specifications evaluated from 1920-1930 show that for these particular subsets of Klansmen, doxxing did have large and statistically significant effects. Table 7 shows that self-employed Klansmen who were doxxed were 7.3 percentage points (18.5%)

more likely to move across county lines and 9.1 percentage points (13.5%) more likely to change industries of employment by 1930 relative to unexposed Klansmen in their county or doxxed Klansmen who were not self-employed.

Table 7: Within-County Comparison: 1920-1930 (Self-Employed)

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed x Post	0.013 (0.026)	-0.032 (0.035)	-0.006 (0.049)	-0.039 (0.044)	-0.347 (0.582)
↑ x Self-Emp.	-0.002 (0.017)	0.073** (0.026)	-0.008 (0.034)	0.091** (0.031)	-0.860 (0.577)
Num.Obs.	12 465	12 465	8924	9474	12 320
R2	0.652	0.652	0.745	0.779	0.816
1920 Mean	0.194	0.394	0.688	0.676	28.33
Individual FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
County-Year FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

Table 8 shows that doxxed Klansmen living in enumeration districts with an above-median share of nonwhite residents were 4.1 percentage points (10.4%) more likely to move across county lines and 5.4 percentage points (8%) more likely to change industries of employment by 1930 relative to unexposed Klansmen in their county. At the 10% level, doxxed Klansmen in these minority districts were also 2.7 percentage points (13.9%) more likely to move across state lines.

These results persist when we expand the analysis window to 1910-1940 with very similar estimated coefficients and slightly higher significance. Taken together, these results show that while doxxing did not have statistically significant effects on migration and labor market outcomes for Klansmen overall, this result masks significant heterogeneity in the impact of being doxxed on individual Klansmen. These findings lend support to the potential role of consumer boycotts in acting as a mechanism for the effect of being doxxed.

Table 8: Within-County Comparison: 1920-1930 (Minority District)

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed x Post	0.000 (0.027)	-0.077* (0.036)	-0.031 (0.050)	-0.044 (0.045)	-0.527 (0.599)
↑ x Minority ED	0.027+ (0.015)	0.118*** (0.022)	0.046 (0.028)	0.054* (0.025)	0.013 (0.385)
Num.Obs.	12 465	12 465	8924	9474	12 320
R2	0.652	0.653	0.745	0.778	0.816
1920 Mean	0.194	0.394	0.688	0.676	28.33
Individual FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
County-Year FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

6 Across-County Comparisons

In my second specification, described in section 4.2, I compare exposed and unexposed Klansmen from different counties. This specification allows me to use almost all of the Klan member data I’ve collected, including all but 300 of the exposed Klan members listed in *Tolerance*.¹² However, because I compare doxxed Klansmen to unexposed Klansmen from different counties, my estimates will capture the potentially heterogeneous effects of Klan membership in different parts of the country in addition to the effect of being doxxed.

Table 9 examines balance on 1920 observables between Klansmen in counties where *Tolerance* did and did not expose Klan membership. There are several differences between the two groups. At the 5% significance level, we see that Klansmen in counties that were eventually exposed were about a year younger, had slightly higher occupational income scores, and were more likely to own their home, live in a rural area, and be married.¹³ Unlike in the within-county specifications, these differences seem to have an effect on our outcomes of interest in 1920 as well. Klansmen from eventually exposed counties were much less likely to move

¹²Of all the exposed Klansmen listed in *Tolerance*, I only exclude those from Denver, CO, as Denver is the main source of my unexposed Klan member data.

¹³At the 10% level, Klansmen from exposed counties were also more likely to live on a farm in 1920.

across state and county lines from 1910 to 1920 (-13.9 p.p. and -9 p.p., respectively).¹⁴ These level differences raise concern that there may be parallel trends issues between the exposed and unexposed counties, which I examine further with event study specifications.

Table 9: Balance of 1920 Observables Across Counties

	Unexposed (N=3719)		Exposed (N=5203)		Diff. in Means	Std. Error
	Mean	Std. Dev.	Mean	Std. Dev.		
Age	35.390	13.038	34.073	12.500	-1.316	0.275
Occscore	28.054	10.994	28.564	10.574	0.510	0.248
Rural	0.169	0.375	0.222	0.415	0.052	0.008
Farmer	0.096	0.294	0.106	0.308	0.010	0.006
Owner	0.435	0.496	0.480	0.500	0.046	0.011
Married	0.645	0.479	0.668	0.471	0.023	0.010
Δ State	0.267	0.442	0.128	0.334	-0.139	0.010
Δ County	0.424	0.494	0.333	0.471	-0.090	0.011
Δ Occupation	0.670	0.470	0.677	0.468	0.007	0.014
Δ Industry	0.649	0.478	0.675	0.468	0.027	0.014

Means of 1920 observables for Klansmen in counties where the American Unity League did or did not acquire membership rolls and publish Klansmen's names, addresses, and occupations in *Tolerance*.

Table 10 shows the results from 1920-1930 of the 2x2 difference-in-differences setup shown in equation 4. In this specification, I find that exposed Klansmen are 8.1 percentage points more likely to move out of state by 1930 relative to unexposed Klansmen, but are no more likely to move across counties within their state, change occupations or industries, or experience changes in their occupational income score.

Extending the period of analysis from 1910-1940, the results in Table 11 show that exposed Klansmen are more likely to move across state and county lines (9.4 p.p. and 13.7 p.p., respectively) and experience a small boost in occupational income score after exposure (0.467 units) relative to their unexposed counterparts. Exposed Klansmen are no more or less likely to change jobs or industries in 1930 or 1940, suggesting that the observed increase

¹⁴At the 10% level, Klansmen from exposed counties were also more likely to change industries from 1910-1920.

Table 10: Across-County Comparison: 1920-1930

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed	-0.139*** (0.035)	-0.090* (0.040)	0.007 (0.021)	0.027 (0.029)	0.510 (0.997)
After	-0.103*** (0.020)	-0.137*** (0.023)	-0.056** (0.017)	0.001 (0.016)	1.732*** (0.120)
Exposed x After	0.081*** (0.021)	0.018 (0.025)	-0.013 (0.018)	-0.033 (0.022)	-0.088 (0.176)
Intercept	0.267*** (0.034)	0.424*** (0.036)	0.670*** (0.019)	0.649*** (0.029)	28.054*** (0.866)
Num.Obs.	14 772	14 772	10 644	11 293	14 608
R2	0.026	0.026	0.004	0.001	0.006
1920 Mean	0.183	0.369	0.674	0.665	28.353

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Standard errors clustered at the source location are shown in parentheses.

in occupational income score is not due to changing occupations more frequently, but may be driven by transitioning to relatively higher paying occupations when switches do occur.

Table 11: Across-County Comparison: 1910-1940

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed	-0.146*** (0.037)	-0.205*** (0.057)	-0.006 (0.017)	-0.001 (0.033)	-0.019 (1.013)
After	-0.127*** (0.022)	-0.274*** (0.044)	-0.097*** (0.017)	-0.009 (0.022)	2.458*** (0.077)
Exposed x After	0.094*** (0.023)	0.137** (0.045)	-0.007 (0.018)	-0.013 (0.024)	0.467*** (0.120)
Intercept	0.277*** (0.036)	0.546*** (0.054)	0.682*** (0.017)	0.650*** (0.032)	27.294*** (0.894)
Num.Obs.	26 432	26 432	17 704	18 200	24 703
R2	0.031	0.066	0.010	0.000	0.015
1920 Mean	0.183	0.369	0.674	0.665	28.353

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Standard errors clustered at the source location are shown in parentheses.

However, the associated event studies shown in Figure A3 cast doubt on the reliability

of these estimates. Looking at the effect of being doxxed on migration behavior (Figures [A3a-A3b](#)), I find a statistically significant negative $\hat{\beta}_{-2}$ in both event studies, indicating that Klansmen living in counties that would eventually be exposed by *Tolerance* were already behaving differently in 1910 relative to Klansmen in the control counties. Specifically, they were 1.6 percentage points less likely to move out of state and 26.7 percentage points less likely to move across county lines in 1910 (relative to the 1920 difference between Klansmen in exposed and unexposed counties).

Similar issues arise when looking at labor market outcomes in Figures [A3c-A3e](#). Relative to their baseline difference in 1920, Klansmen living in eventually exposed counties were 9.8 percentage points less likely to change industries in 1910, and their 1910 occupational income scores were 1.26 units lower. These significant negative pre-trends cast doubt on the validity of the parallel trends assumption, and therefore on the causal nature of the DiD and event study estimates.

In order to address these concerns, I implement the sensitivity analyses outlined in Rambachan and Roth (2023). Rambachan and Roth’s methods allow for partial identification of the DiD estimator by placing restrictions on how potential post-treatment parallel trend violations relate to observed pre-treatment parallel trend violations. For example, if we impose that the confounding factors driving parallel trend violations in the pre-period do not change in the post-period ($\bar{M} = 1$, i.e., the pre-trends continue at the same rate into the post-period), then we can partially identify a treatment effect in the post-period by accounting for this trend. We can alter this value of $\bar{M}$ to see what range of violations still allow us to estimate a statistically significant effect. I use Rambachan and Roth’s method to see what range of violations would allow for jointly significant $\hat{\beta}_0$ and $\hat{\beta}_1$ from equation 5 for all outcomes of interest. Results are shown in Figure [A4](#) in section [B.2.1](#).

The sensitivity analyses show that for a series of $\bar{M}$ values ranging from 0 to 2, corresponding to no post-treatment parallel trend violations to double the pre-trend violations in the post-period, there is no statistically significant effect of being doxxed on members’

likelihood of intrastate migration, changing occupations, or changing industries, and no statistically significant effect on occupational income scores. The only result that retains its significance is that doxxed Klansmen are more likely to move out of state relative to their unexposed counterparts; even if the magnitude of the pre-trend parallel trends violations doubled in the post-period, this result retains its sign and significance. However, this result should still be treated with caution, as it may be driven by underlying differences in the treated and control groups' composition rather than a true underlying treatment effect. See section C.1.3 for further discussion and explanation.

Taken together, the results from the cross-county comparisons do not indicate any statistically significant effects of being outed as a member of the second Klan. Klansmen from counties where members were exposed do not differ significantly in terms of migration rates within their state or any labor market outcomes. There is limited evidence of higher interstate migration rates among doxxed members after treatment, but this seems to be driven by Denver's outsized role in the composition of the control group rather than a true underlying treatment effect.

7 Conclusion

In this paper, I present the first quantitative evidence on the long-run effectiveness of doxxing. Linking members of the Second Ku Klux Klan identified through archival records and the anti-Klan publication *Tolerance* to the 1900-1940 censuses, I find that doxxed Klansmen from Denver County, CO and Marion County, IN largely fared no differently relative to unexposed Klansmen in their counties. Overall, exposed Klansmen were no more or less likely to move across state or county lines, switch occupations, or change industries of employment, and experienced no statistically significant increases or decreases in their occupational income scores. In specifications comparing exposed and unexposed Klan members across counties, after accounting for potential parallel trends violations I again find limited

evidence that being doxxed had a statistically significant effect on any outcomes of interest.

However, doxxing did carry large and statistically significant effects for a subset of Klansmen whose membership revelation was particularly salient: those who were self-employed and lived in enumeration districts with a relatively higher share of nonwhite residents. This result highlights the potential mechanism of consumer boycotts and backlash in driving the effects of doxxing on individuals' migratory and labor market outcomes.

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A Additional Exhibits

Table A1: Exposed Klan Member Locations

Location	Name	Address	Occupation	Source n
Casper, WY	x	x	x	191
Chicago, IL	x	x	x	606
Danville, IL	x	x	x	102
Dayton, OH	x	x	x	444
Denver, CO	x	x	x	304
Dubuque, IA	x	x	x	202
Fort Wayne, IN	x	x	x	304
Indianapolis, IN	x	x	-	10, 268
Logansport, IN	x	x	x	287
Peoria, IL	x	x	x	482
Racine, WI	x	x	x	252
Roundup, MT	x	x	x	279
South Bend, IN	x	-	x	268
Springfield, OH	x	-	x	146
St. Louis, MO	x	-	x	402
Warren, OH	x	x	x	222
Washington, DC	x	x	x	157
Youngstown, OH	x	x	x	221

The table above shows the member information available in *Tolerance* issues for cities with at least 100 exposed members. In each column, “x” indicates the presence of the characteristic while “-” indicates its absence.

Table A2: Unexposed Klan Member Locations

Location	Source n	Source
Denver County, CO	29, 635	History Colorado
Hamilton County, IN	453	Indiana Historical Society
Knox County, TN	445	Emory University Libraries
Marion County, IN	922	Indiana Historical Society
Total	31, 445	

Figure A1: John Bowman's Knoxville Dues Card

B Event Study Results

B.1 Within-County: Exposed vs. Unexposed

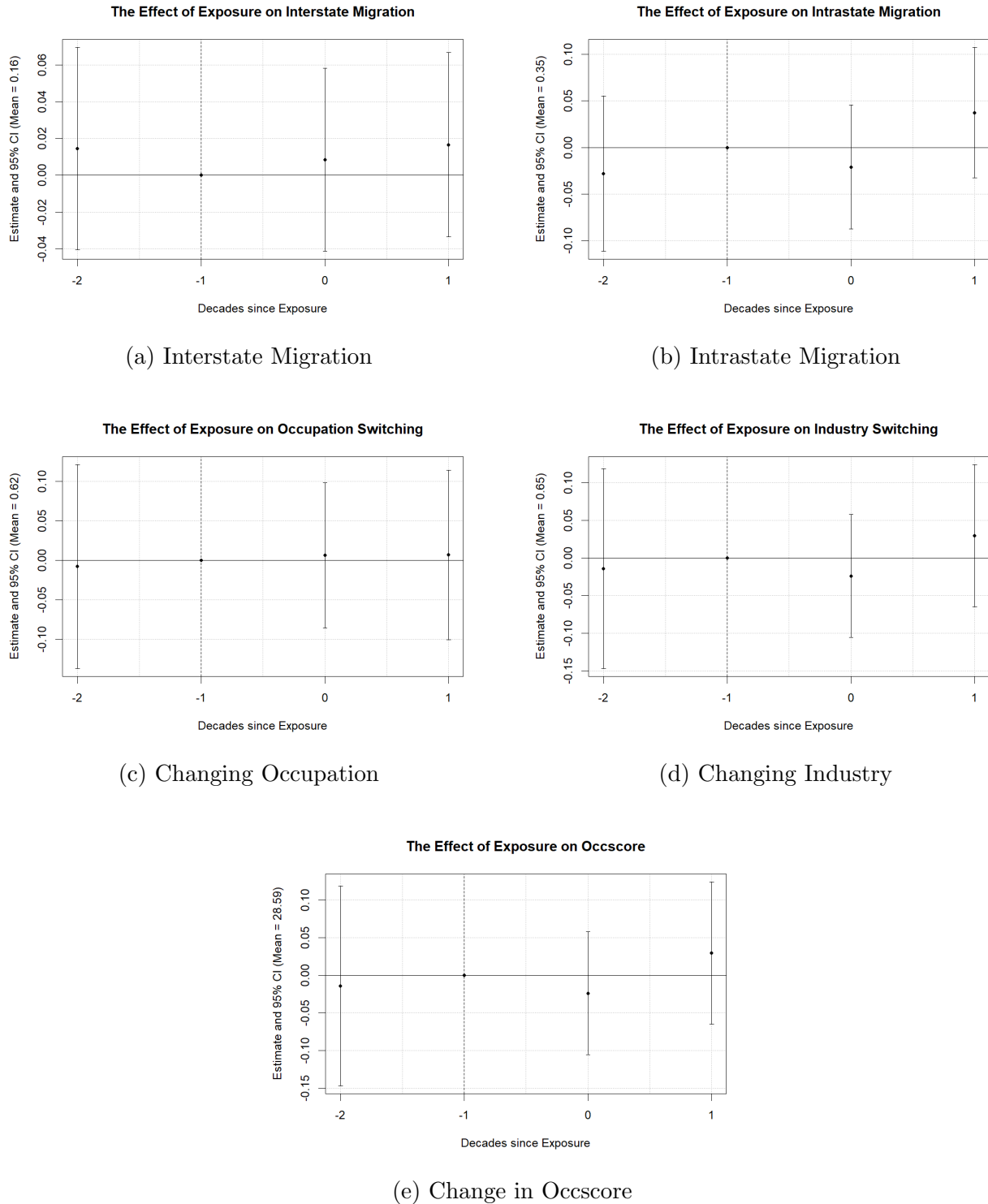
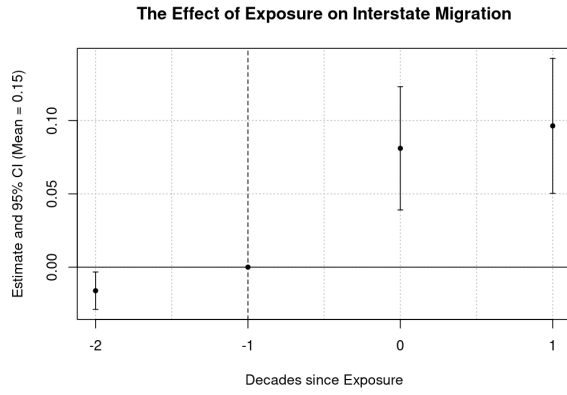
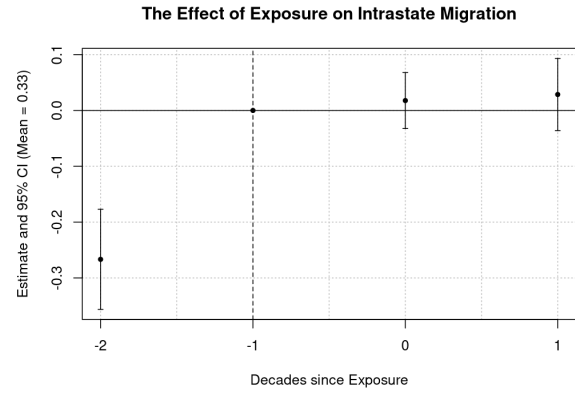


Figure A2: Within-County Event Studies

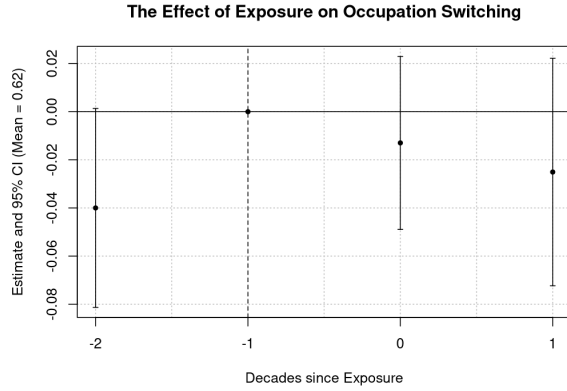
B.2 Across-County: Exposed vs. Unexposed



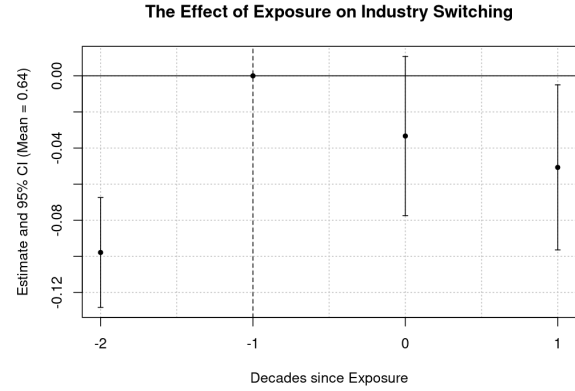
(a) Interstate Migration



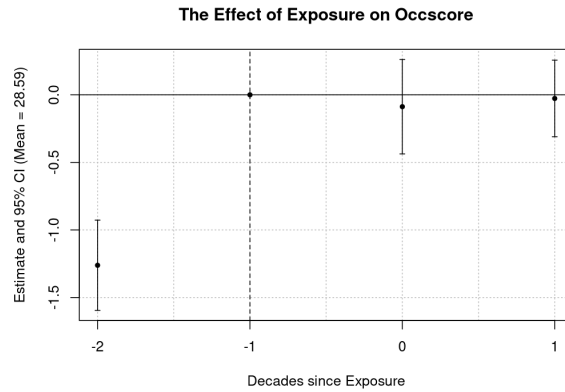
(b) Intrastate Migration



(c) Changing Occupation



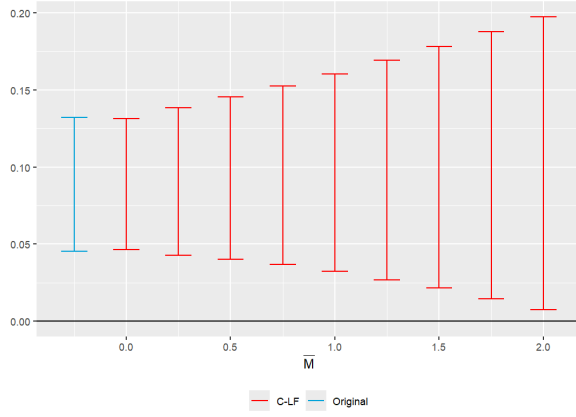
(d) Changing Industry



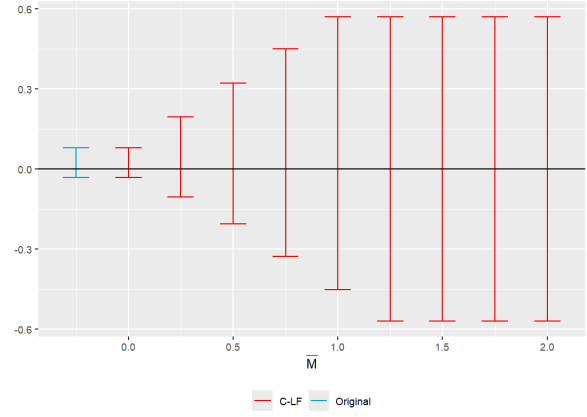
(e) Change in Occscore

Figure A3: Across-County Event Studies

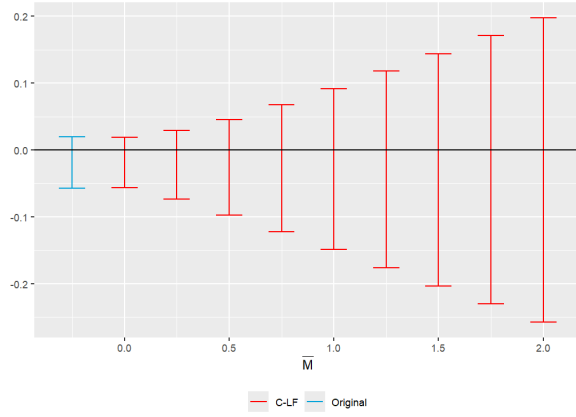
B.2.1 Sensitivity Analysis: HonestDiD



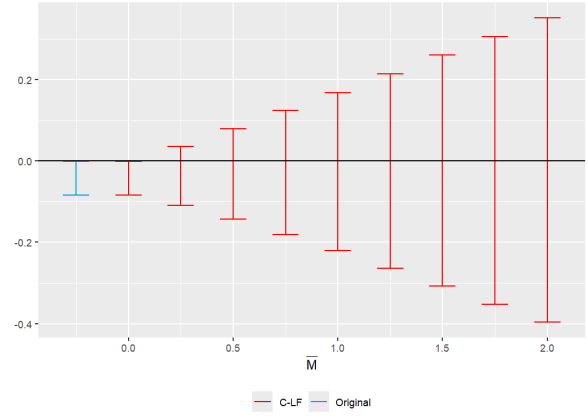
(a) Interstate Migration



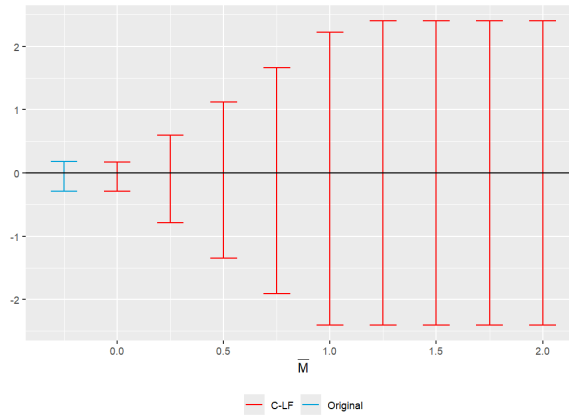
(b) Intrastate Migration



(c) Changing Occupation



(d) Changing Industry



(e) Change in Occscore

Figure A4: Across-County Event Studies

C Alternative Specifications

C.1 Within-County Robustness Checks

The preferred specification for my within-county analysis is a difference-in-differences setup with individual and county-by-time fixed effects estimated on a pooled sample containing exposed and unexposed members from Denver, CO and Marion County, IN. In this section I present several alternative specifications exploiting within-county variation. First, I focus on Denver County, CO alone and estimate the effect of being doxxed using two-way fixed effects (id and year) and a standard 2x2 setup. I then repeat these specifications on a sample consisting of only Marion County Klansmen and a pooled sample consisting of exposed and unexposed members from both counties. For the latter, I explain why the observed effects are driven by sample composition rather than underlying treatment effects.

C.1.1 Denver County, CO Only

I start by running the single-location analog of our main specification from equation 2, which is a TWFE model with individual and time (decade) fixed effects:

$$Y_{it} = \beta(Exposed_i \times Post_t) + \gamma_i + \phi_t + e_{it} \quad (7)$$

Because we're looking at a single county, no c subscripts or county-by-time interactions are necessary. I also run a standard 2x2 difference-in-differences model for robustness. In both specifications, standard errors are clustered at the individual level corresponding with the unit of treatment. The results from both specifications are shown below.

The results in Tables A3 and A4 indicate that doxxing has no statistically significant effect on Denver Klansmen's likelihood of migrating across state or county lines, switching jobs, or changing industries of employment, and leads to no statistically significant increases/decreases in occupational income scores. These results are fully consistent with

Table A3: Denver County Only: 1910-1940

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed x Post	0.048 (0.062)	0.026 (0.055)	0.110 (0.098)	0.059 (0.068)	-0.837 (1.324)
Num.Obs.	9425	9425	6329	6490	8985
R2	0.405	0.449	0.561	0.584	0.692
1920 Mean	0.296	0.453	0.687	0.674	29
Individual FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Year FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

+ p <0.1, * p <0.05, ** p <0.01, *** p <0.001

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

Table A4: Denver County Only: 1910-1940

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed	-0.020 (0.039)	-0.031 (0.032)	0.045 (0.057)	0.077 (0.064)	7.407*** (1.657)
After	-0.147*** (0.009)	-0.312*** (0.009)	-0.112*** (0.012)	-0.026* (0.012)	2.408*** (0.214)
Exposed x After	0.063 (0.055)	-0.002 (0.050)	-0.017 (0.080)	-0.033 (0.070)	-0.403 (1.312)
(Intercept)	0.309*** (0.007)	0.593*** (0.006)	0.697*** (0.010)	0.677*** (0.010)	28.073*** (0.192)
Num.Obs.	9425	9425	6329	6490	8985
R2	0.030	0.099	0.013	0.001	0.021
1920 Mean	0.296	0.453	0.687	0.674	29.000

+ p <0.1, * p <0.05, ** p <0.01, *** p <0.001

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

the findings presented and discussed in section 5.

C.1.2 Marion County, IN Only

I also run the two regressions described above on a subsample of exposed and unexposed Klansmen from Marion County, IN. The results are presented below.

Table A5: Marion County Only: 1910-1940

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed x Post	−0.004 (0.020)	0.013 (0.031)	−0.020 (0.051)	−0.017 (0.046)	−0.695 (0.530)
Num.Obs.	12 789	12 789	8480	8721	11 773
R2	0.434	0.410	0.547	0.595	0.699
1920 Mean	0.119	0.351	0.69	0.677	27.785
Individual FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Year FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

Table A6: Marion County Only: 1910-1940

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed	0.033* (0.014)	0.015 (0.022)	−0.043 (0.033)	−0.032 (0.036)	2.334*** (0.494)
After	−0.013 (0.017)	−0.152*** (0.028)	−0.109** (0.040)	−0.061 (0.039)	3.448*** (0.499)
Exposed x After	−0.012 (0.018)	0.005 (0.029)	0.011 (0.041)	0.051 (0.041)	−0.465 (0.537)
(Intercept)	0.092*** (0.013)	0.346*** (0.021)	0.721*** (0.032)	0.681*** (0.035)	24.374*** (0.462)
Num.Obs.	12 789	12 789	8480	8721	11 773
R2	0.002	0.027	0.010	0.000	0.022
1920 Mean	0.119	0.351	0.690	0.677	27.785

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

Once again, the results presented in Tables A5 and A6 show no that doxxing has no

statistically significant effect on any outcomes of interest, consistent with the findings in 5 and the results from the Denver sample alone.

C.1.3 Pooled Sample

In a third set of robustness checks, I employ alternative specifications using a sample containing all exposed and unexposed Klansmen from Denver and Marion counties. I first estimate a TWFE specification with individual and time (decade) fixed effects but no county-by-year fixed effects. This means I no longer control for county-specific time shocks and am relying on cross-county comparisons in addition to within-county comparisons to inform my estimates. Results are presented in Table A7.

Table A7: Pooled Sample: 1910-1940

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed x Post	0.111*** (0.011)	0.153*** (0.013)	0.003 (0.019)	−0.004 (0.018)	0.375 (0.250)
Num.Obs.	22 214	22 214	14 809	15 211	22 706
R2	0.432	0.428	0.552	0.590	0.677
1920 Mean	0.194	0.394	0.688	0.676	28.33
Individual FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Year FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

+ p <0.1, * p <0.05, ** p <0.01, *** p <0.001

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

The results from the TWFE on a pooled sample differ significantly from the baseline results in 5 or the single-county regressions discussed above. According to these results, doxxed Klansmen are 11.1 percentage points more likely to migrate across state lines and 15.3 percentage points more likely to migrate across county lines relative to unexposed Klansmen. These estimates indicate a 57% increase in interstate migration rates and a 29% increase in intrastate migration rates relative to 1920 means. If we instead estimate a standard 2x2 setup, we find largely similar results, presented below.

In Table A8, we again see large and statistically significant increases in interstate migra-

Table A8: Pooled Sample: 1910-1940

	Interstate	Intrastate	Occupation	Industry	Occscore
Exposed	−0.159*** (0.008)	−0.204*** (0.009)	−0.019 (0.013)	−0.026+ (0.014)	−1.037*** (0.254)
After	−0.134*** (0.008)	−0.297*** (0.008)	−0.111*** (0.012)	−0.030** (0.011)	2.951*** (0.202)
Exposed x After	0.108*** (0.010)	0.146*** (0.012)	0.012 (0.016)	0.019 (0.016)	0.688* (0.284)
(Intercept)	0.288*** (0.006)	0.569*** (0.006)	0.699*** (0.009)	0.677*** (0.010)	27.243*** (0.181)
Num.Obs.	22 214	22 214	14 809	15 211	22 706
R2	0.036	0.076	0.011	0.001	0.023
1920 Mean	0.194	0.394	0.688	0.676	28.330

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Standard errors clustered at the individual level are shown in parentheses.

tion rates, intrastate migration rates, and occupational income scores. According to these results, doxxed Klansmen are 10.8 and 14.6 percentage points more likely to move across state and county lines, respectively, and experience a 0.688 unit (2.4%) increase in occupational income scores. However, these results do not seem to be driven by underlying treatment effects, but instead by treatment and control group composition and pre-existing differences in observables between Denver and Marion counties. I demonstrate this below, drawing from the mapping of 2x2 DiD coefficients to conditional means in Angrist and Pischke (2009) and decompositions from Gelbach (2016).

For example, consider the coefficient on Exposed for the interstate migration outcome in the pooled sample, presented in Table A8, which we'll denote as β_1^P . Denoting the conditional mean of Y as μ_{ea} , where e indicates exposure status and a indicates after, we can express β_1^P as:

$$\beta_1^P = \mu_{10}^P - \mu_{00}^P$$

These μ_{ea}^P values can be represented as weighted averages of Denver means, μ_{ea}^D , and Marion

means, μ_{ea}^M , with weights w_{ea} representing the share of observations within that ea cell coming from Denver ($w_{ea} = \Pr(Denver|a, e)$):

$$\mu_{ea}^P = \mu_{ea}^D w_{ea} + \mu_{ea}^M (1 - w_{ea})$$

Using this identity and noting that $\mu_{10}^g = \mu_{00}^g + \beta_1^g$ for $g \in \{D, M\}$, we can decompose β_1^P into two parts: a weighted average of the single-location coefficients and a composition term:

$$\begin{aligned} \beta_1^P &= \mu_{10}^P - \mu_{00}^P \\ &= [\mu_{10}^D w_{10} + \mu_{10}^M (1 - w_{10})] - [\mu_{00}^D w_{00} + \mu_{00}^M (1 - w_{00})] \\ &= [(\mu_{00}^D + \beta_1^D) w_{10} + (\mu_{00}^M + \beta_1^M) (1 - w_{10})] - [\mu_{00}^D w_{00} + \mu_{00}^M (1 - w_{00})] \\ &= \underbrace{w_{10} \beta_1^D + (1 - w_{10}) \beta_1^M}_{\text{average of single-location } \beta\text{ s}} + \underbrace{(w_{10} - w_{00})(\mu_{00}^D - \mu_{00}^M)}_{\text{composition term}}. \end{aligned}$$

In our pooled sample, the vast majority of exposed individuals come from Marion County and the majority of unexposed members come from Denver. Therefore, the Denver weights w_{ea} are very uneven. Specifically, $w_{00} = 0.90$ and $w_{01} = 0.89$ while $w_{10} = 0.02$ and $w_{11} = 0.02$. Plugging in these weights, conditional means, and the interstate β_1 values from Tables A4, A6, and A8, we can see that β_1^P is driven almost entirely by composition rather than true underlying treatment effects.

$$\begin{aligned} \beta_1^P &= [w_{10} \beta_1^D + (1 - w_{10}) \beta_1^M] + [(w_{10} - w_{00})(\mu_{00}^D - \mu_{00}^M)] \\ &= [(0.02)(-0.020) + (1 - 0.02)(0.033)] + [(0.02 - 0.90)(0.309 - 0.092)] \\ &= 0.0319 + (-0.1909) \\ &= -0.159 \end{aligned}$$

This same decomposition can be applied to the remaining coefficients to show that the presented significant coefficients on migration rates and occupational income scores are not

due to treatment effects of being doxxed, but rather large imbalances in source location across exposed and unexposed groups (w_{10} and w_{00}) and pre-existing differences between Denver and Marion counties (μ_{00}^D and μ_{00}^M). Because Denver still serves as the largest source of unexposed individuals in the across-county specification detailed in section 4.2, the results presented in section 6 will also suffer from this issue.